Begum Ozdemir-Oluk

Contact

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Research Interests	Environmental and Behavioral Economics.
Pronouns	She/Her.

Education

2020–2026	**Ph.D. in Economics & Finance**, *magna cum laude*, University of St. Gallen (HSG), Switzerland.
2018–2020	**M.S. in Economics; Minor in Mathematics**, University of North Texas (UNT), Texas, USA.
2016–2018	**M.A. in Economics**, Bilkent University, Ankara, Turkiye.
2011–2016	**B.Sc. in Management (Finance specialization)**, Bilkent University, Ankara, Turkiye.

Research Positions and Affiliations

2026–present	Research Affiliate, Sustainability, Transparency, and Accountability Research (STAR) Lab, Harvard University, USA.
2026–present	Research Affiliate, Swiss Institute for International Economics and Applied Economic Research (SIAW-HSG), University of St. Gallen, Switzerland.
2020–2025	Doctoral Researcher, Swiss Federal Institute of Aquatic Science & Technology, Department of Environmental Social Sciences, Switzerland.

Job Market Paper

Transparency of carbon-neutral labels: evidence from a choice experiment – **Revise and Resubmit** at ***Environmental and Resource Economics (ERE)***.

This paper examines whether transparency affects consumers' willingness to pay for carbon-neutral labels. Many companies label products as carbon neutral, yet these labels do not disclose the shares of CO_2 offsetting and CO_2 reduction underlying the claim. The EU has recently adopted rules to prohibit environmental claims that rely on CO_2 offsetting, while other jurisdictions, such as the UK, have issued guidance recommending disclosure. Using a discrete choice experiment with 1,339 UK tea consumers, I compare willingness to pay for standard versus transparent carbon-neutral labels that disclose the offset–reduction composition. I find no evidence that transparency increases willingness to pay or that consumers prefer CO_2 reductions over offsets. Furthermore, organic and ethical trade labels crowd out the value of the carbon-neutral claim but do not change the null effect of transparency. These findings suggest that disclosure alone may not be sufficient to ensure quality differentiation in carbon-neutral labeling and that additional regulation may be needed.

Working Papers

Demand for carbon-neutral products, with Stefano Carattini, Fabian Dvorak, and Ivana Logar – **Resubmitted** to ***Journal of Environmental Economics and Management (JEEM)***.

Publications (Pre-Dissertation)

Neyapti, B., & Özdemir Oluk, B. (2021). Fiscal Transfers in Turkey: Do Politics Matter? *Economic Systems, 45*(3), 100909.

Peer-Review Service

2025–present Ad hoc reviewer, *Journal of Behavioral and Experimental Economics*.

Seminars

2026 Apr – Seminar, Institute of Responsible Innovation, Sustainability and Energy (RISE), University of St. Gallen, Switzerland.

2024 Dec – Seminar, School of Economics and Political Science (SEPS), University of St. Gallen, Switzerland.
Mar – Colloquium, Department of Environmental Social Sciences (ESS), Eawag, Dubendorf, Switzerland.

Conferences and Workshops

2026 Apr – HSG Academic Poster Session, HSG Responsibility & Sustainability Services, University of St. Gallen, Switzerland.

2025 Jun – Annual Congress of the Swiss Society of Economics and Statistics (SSES), ETH Zurich, Switzerland.
JEEM/REE Workshop on Nonmarket Valuation, Bergen, Norway.
30th Annual Conference of the European Association of Environmental and Resource Economists (EAERE), Bergen, Norway.
Jan – ETH Domain Conference: Social Sciences on Environment, Technology and Sustainability, Dubendorf, Switzerland.

2024 Sep – Workshop on Experimental Economics for the Environment (EE4E), Bochum, Germany.
Eawag Symposium, Dubendorf, Switzerland.
Jul – 29th Annual Conference of the European Association of Environmental and Resource Economists (EAERE), Leuven, Belgium.
Jun – European Association of Environmental and Resource Economists (EAERE) Summer School: Data Science in Environmental Economics Research, Graz, Austria.
Monte Verità Conference on Sustainable Resource Use and Economic Dynamics (SURED), Ascona, Switzerland.
Feb – Choice Experiment Clinics, VU Amsterdam, Netherlands.
Jan – Workshop on Empirical Methods in Energy Economics (EMEE), ETH Zurich, Switzerland.

2023 Oct – Graduate Program in Economics and Finance PhD Day, University of St. Gallen, Switzerland.

2022 Sep – Eawag Symposium, Dubendorf, Switzerland.

2021 Sep – Eawag Symposium, Dubendorf, Switzerland.

Teaching Experience

2019–2020 Teaching Assistant, University of North Texas (UNT), Texas, USA.
Advanced Microeconomic Theory (ECON 5340); Intermediate Microeconomics (ECON 3550).

2016–2018 Teaching Assistant, Bilkent University, Ankara, Turkiye.
Macroeconomic Theory II (ECON 206); Monetary Economics (ECON 322); History of Economic Thought (ECON 363); Econometrics (ECON 301).

Technical & Language Skills

Software & Tools	R; Stata; Ngene; LaTeX.
Languages	Turkish (native); English (advanced); German (elementary).

References

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